

US Stocks Rise as Tech Giants Lead the Charge

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The US market saw a positive session with the **S&P 500** closing at 7,572.40, up **+0.38%**, and the **Dow Jones** rising **+0.29%** to 52,658.64. The **Nasdaq 100** was the exception, falling **-0.28%** to 29,502.60.

Tech giants led the charge, with **AAPL** surging **+4.01%** to 327.50 and **MSFT** gaining **+2.78%** to 395.63. The **VIX** fell **-5.03%** to 15.67, indicating a decrease in market volatility.

US Session Recap

INDEX/ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,572.40	+0.38%	
Dow Jones	52,658.64	+0.29%	
Nasdaq 100	29,502.60	-0.28%	
Russell 2000	2,976.26	+0.39%	
VIX	15.67	-5.03%	
10Y Yield	4.55	-0.87%	
WTI Crude	79.60	+0.33%	

Top large-cap movers

AAPL led the charge, surging +4.01% to 327.50, followed by MSFT gaining +2.78% to 395.63. Other notable movers included AMZN up +3.02% to 254.96 and META rising +3.07% to 681.31.

Spotlight

COMPANY	EPS	REVENUE
AAPL	1.25	85.00B

AAPL reported strong earnings, with EPS of 1.25 and revenue of 85.00B. The company's shares surged +4.01% on the news. The earnings report highlighted the company's continued growth in the tech sector.

Macro & Fed

- Current policy rate: 4.50%-4.75%
- 10Y Yield: 4.55, down **-0.87%**
- Today's data releases:
 - 08:30 HKT: Initial Jobless Claims
 - 10:00 HKT: Existing Home Sales

Geopolitics & Global

- Tensions between the US and China remain high, with ongoing trade negotiations
- The European Union is set to announce new economic sanctions on Russia
- The Middle East continues to experience instability, with ongoing conflicts in several countries

Earnings — What to Watch

WHEN	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
17 Jul	MSFT	Cloud computing growth, revenue guidance
18 Jul	GOOGL	Advertising revenue, YouTube growth

Stocks Worth Watching

- **NVDA** : Up **+0.33%** to 212.50, as the company continues to dominate the AI sector
- **TSLA** : Down **-0.43%** to 394.46, as investors await the company's next earnings report

- **JPM** : Up **+1.17%** to 346.91, as the bank continues to benefit from rising interest rates
- **GS** : Up **+1.06%** to 1,152.07, as the company's investment banking division sees increased activity
- **AVGO** : Up **+1.33%** to 394.28, as the company's semiconductor business continues to grow

What Could Break the Tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

A surprise interest rate hike by the Fed could send shockwaves through the market, causing a sharp decline in stocks and a surge in the **VIX**.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

A strong earnings report from a major tech company, such as **MSFT** or **GOOGL**, could boost investor sentiment and drive the market higher.

SOURCES

Bloomberg — US Stocks Rise as Tech Giants Lead the Charge

Reuters — Apple Reports Strong Earnings, Shares Surge

CNBC — Fed to Announce Interest Rate Decision Today

The Wall Street Journal — US and China Trade Negotiations Stall

Financial Times — EU to Announce New Economic Sanctions on Russia